

## IT PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO

Cloud Engineering and Security Projects

### PROJECT 08

# Create an AWS Organization, Security OU, and SecurityAudit Account

AWS Organizations | Multi-Account Governance | Security OU

|              |                  |
|--------------|------------------|
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| ENVIRONMENT  | Personal AWS Lab |
| VERSION      | v1.0.0           |
| RELEASE DATE | July 9, 2026     |
| STATUS       | Complete         |

## Executive Summary

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Enabled AWS Organizations from the existing management account, created a **Security** Organizational Unit (OU), created a new AWS member account named **SecurityAudit**, and moved that account into the Security OU. This project established the first multi-account governance structure in the portfolio and created a dedicated boundary for future centralized security services.

## Business Problem

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As cloud environments grow, placing every workload, security control, and administrative function in a single AWS account increases blast radius and complicates governance. AWS Organizations provides a central hierarchy for managing multiple accounts, while Organizational Units allow accounts with similar security or operational purposes to be grouped and governed together.

## Objectives

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- Enable AWS Organizations from the dedicated management account.
- Create a Security Organizational Unit.
- Create a dedicated AWS member account named SecurityAudit.
- Move the SecurityAudit account into the Security OU.
- Establish a multi-account foundation for future security controls and centralized governance.

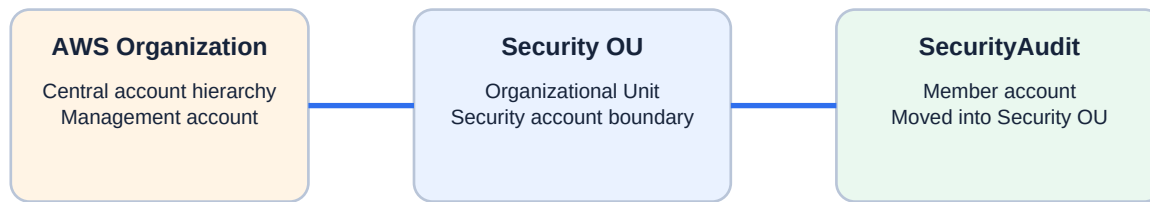
## Environment

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| Cloud Provider       | Amazon Web Services (AWS)                               |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary Service      | AWS Organizations                                       |
| Management Structure | Organization with management account                    |
| Organizational Unit  | Security                                                |
| Member Account       | SecurityAudit                                           |
| Account Placement    | SecurityAudit moved into Security OU                    |
| Purpose              | Multi-account governance and security account isolation |

## Architecture

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The management account owns the organization; the Security OU groups security-focused member accounts.

*SecurityAudit is an AWS member account, not an IAM user.*

*Figure 1 - Initial AWS Organizations security account hierarchy.*

## Implementation Summary

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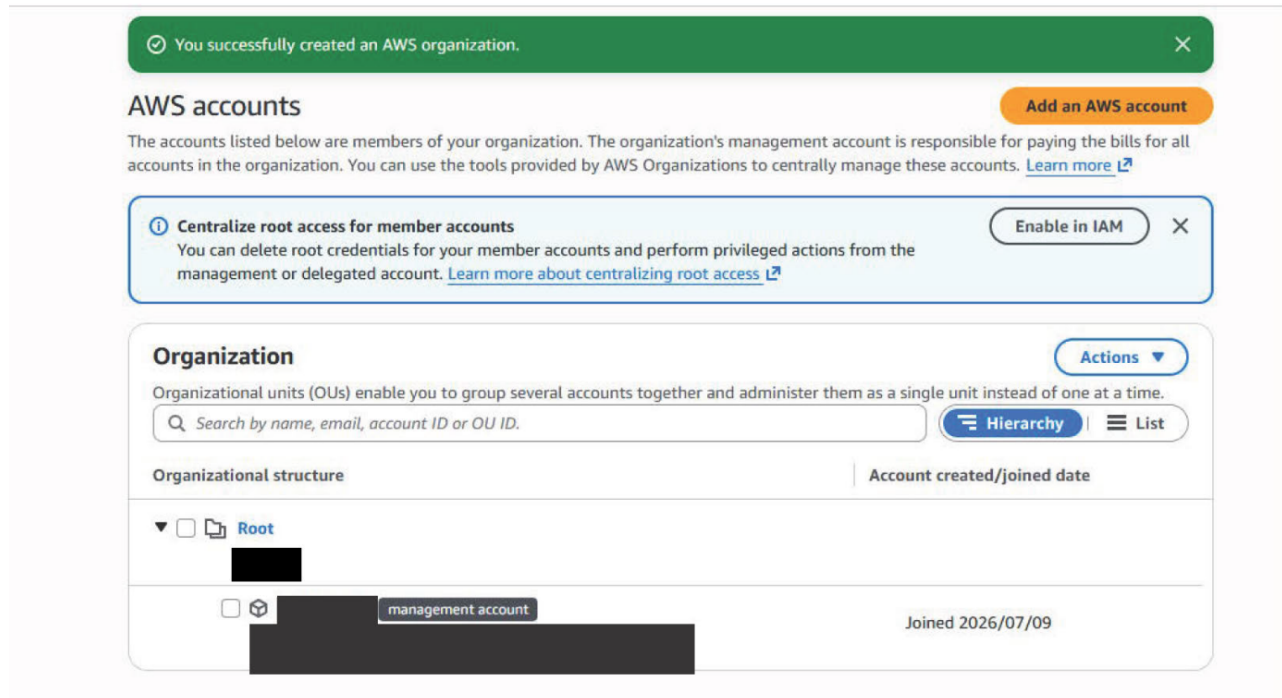
1. Opened AWS Organizations from the dedicated management account.
2. Created the AWS organization.
3. Created a new Organizational Unit named Security.
4. Created a new AWS member account named SecurityAudit.
5. Moved the SecurityAudit account from the organization root into the Security OU.
6. Validated the final hierarchy showing SecurityAudit nested beneath the Security OU.

### TERMINOLOGY

The item named **SecurityAudit** is documented as an **AWS member account**, not an IAM user. AWS Organizations groups accounts inside OUs; IAM users exist within individual accounts.

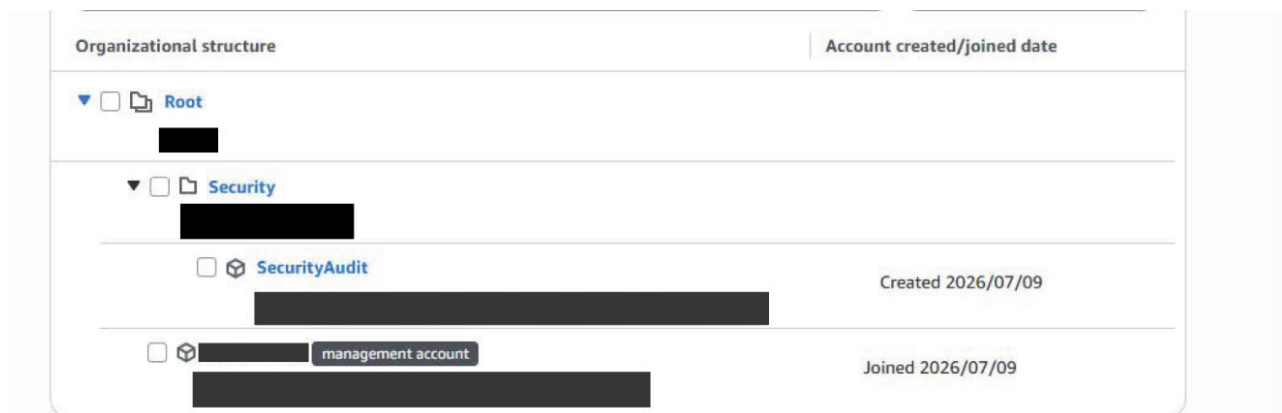
## Evidence

Figure 2 - AWS Organization Successfully Created



The redacted AWS Organizations page displays the success banner confirming that an AWS organization was created. The existing account is shown as the management account beneath the organization root.

Figure 3 - SecurityAudit Account Inside the Security OU



The redacted organizational hierarchy shows the Security OU beneath Root and the SecurityAudit member account nested inside it. The management account remains directly beneath Root.

## Security Analysis

A multi-account strategy reduces blast radius by separating security functions and future workloads into independent account boundaries.

The Security OU provides a logical governance boundary for dedicated security accounts. Future Service Control Policies and centralized security services can be applied at the OU level.

Keeping the management account focused on organization administration reduces the risk created by running ordinary workloads in the account with the highest level of organizational control.

A dedicated SecurityAudit account creates a natural location for future centralized logging, security findings, and audit visibility that should be isolated from workload accounts.

## Lessons Learned

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AWS Organizations manages accounts centrally, while OUs act as containers for grouping accounts with similar governance requirements.

An AWS account is a stronger security and resiliency boundary than an IAM user or role. Multi-account architecture can reduce the impact of compromised workloads or misconfigurations.

The management account should remain highly protected because it controls the organization and can influence member accounts.

## Production Improvements

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- Keep workloads out of the management account and restrict access to organization administrators.
- Enable and test Service Control Policies for OU-level guardrails.
- Use IAM Identity Center for centralized workforce access instead of creating separate IAM users in every account.
- Create additional dedicated accounts for security operations, logging, production, and development as the architecture grows.
- Configure delegated administrator accounts for supported security services.
- Document account ownership, purpose, lifecycle, and emergency access procedures.

## Skills Demonstrated

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| AWS Organizations        | Blast-radius reduction | Multi-account management    |
|--------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Organizational Units     | Account isolation      | Account hierarchy design    |
| Member account placement | Governance boundaries  | Security account foundation |

## Resume Bullet

### RESUME

Established an AWS Organizations multi-account governance structure by creating a Security OU, provisioning a dedicated SecurityAudit member account, and moving the account into the OU to support future centralized security controls and account isolation.

## STAR Interview Story

**Situation:** The AWS lab had grown beyond a single-account security baseline and needed a structure that could support centralized governance and isolated security functions.

**Task:** Create the first multi-account hierarchy and place a dedicated audit account into a security-focused organizational boundary.

**Action:** I enabled AWS Organizations, created the Security OU, created the SecurityAudit member account, moved the account into the OU, and validated the final hierarchy.

**Result:** The environment now has a scalable multi-account governance foundation that can support Service Control Policies, centralized security services, and stronger separation of duties.

## Version History

| v1.0.0 | July 9, 2026 | Initial documented implementation. Created an AWS organization, created the Security OU, created the SecurityAudit member account, moved the account into the Security OU, and embedded all provided project evidence using portfolio documentation standard v1.0.1. |
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## References

- Cloud Security Lab a Week (S.L.A.W.) - Enable AWS Organizations.
- User-provided redacted AWS Organizations creation screenshot.
- User-provided redacted Security OU and SecurityAudit account hierarchy screenshot.